

Revenue Operations in SaaS

Learning portfolio and practical project roadmap

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Purpose

This portfolio brings together my learning about SaaS Revenue Operations, GTM engineering and AI-assisted revenue workflows. It connects operating principles, metrics, technology architecture and proposed projects in one reference document.

The central lesson is that reliable revenue execution starts with clear processes and trustworthy data. Automation becomes valuable when it improves a defined business outcome, and a strong portfolio demonstrates that improvement with evidence.

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How to use this portfolio

Use the first sections as a learning reference and the project section as a build roadmap. Record implementation evidence and measured outcomes as projects are completed. Project descriptions below are proposals and learning examples, rather than claims of completed work.

1 Revenue Operations foundations

Revenue Operations aligns Sales, Marketing and Customer Success around shared processes, data and metrics. Its purpose is to make the revenue journey more consistent and visible, from the first marketing interaction through renewal and expansion.

From separate teams to a shared operating system

In a siloed model, each operations team maintains its own tools, reports and definitions. Pipeline figures can disagree, handoffs can fail, and responsibility for the complete customer journey is unclear. A unified model establishes common definitions, a shared pipeline view and designed handoffs.

An increasingly automated model adds repeatable execution to this foundation. Systems can enrich records, route leads, generate briefings and flag exceptions. People still own the process, review important decisions and monitor whether the system is working.

Four pillars

People and process

Define ownership, stage criteria, qualification rules and handoffs between Marketing, Sales and Customer Success. Agree what a qualified lead and a closed-won deal mean before automating the process.

Technology

Choose, configure and connect the tools used by revenue teams. CRM, marketing automation, engagement, enrichment and analytics must operate as a coherent system.

Data and analytics

Maintain data quality, common definitions and reporting that supports decisions. Inaccurate stages, close dates or revenue values undermine pipeline visibility and forecasts.

Revenue intelligence

Use available evidence to assess deal risk, conversion patterns, renewal health and likely outcomes. AI can assist analysis, but predictions require validation and sufficient context.

RevOps and GTM

Go-to-market defines which customers to pursue, how to reach them, how to sell and how to retain them. RevOps provides the operational infrastructure to execute that strategy. GTM engineering builds workflows and integrations; architecture determines how these systems fit together.

2 The SaaS customer journey

RevOps connects the acquisition and retention journey rather than treating each team as an isolated function. The same definitions and customer context should travel through each handoff.

Ideal customer profile

Define the ICP using company characteristics, customer needs and buying behaviour. Analyse closed-won and closed-lost records to identify which segments fit the product and convert well. AI-assisted research can help surface patterns, while the business decides which criteria matter.

Demand generation and attribution

Marketing creates awareness through content, advertising, events and search. RevOps tracks lead sources, acquisition costs and conversion. Attribution examines which activities are associated with pipeline and revenue; a lead count alone does not explain revenue contribution.

Sales development

SDRs qualify inbound enquiries and prospect target accounts. RevOps defines routing, ownership, response expectations and sequence reporting. Enrichment and ICP scoring can give representatives better context before the first conversation.

Account executives and pipeline execution

AEs manage discovery, demonstrations, proposals, negotiation and closing. RevOps supports stage discipline, deal visibility, forecast reporting and risk detection. Meeting summaries and suggested next actions can reduce manual administration when reviewed for accuracy.

Customer Success and expansion

Customer Success supports adoption, customer value, renewal and expansion. RevOps connects customer health signals, renewal dates and revenue changes. A health model may combine CRM information, conversation evidence and delivery or project status.

Sales enablement

Enablement helps representatives prepare, improve skills and apply consistent processes. Potential outputs include competitive battlecards, onboarding guides, outbound sequences and call coaching reports. Differences in win rates should be investigated in context, including territory, deal mix and experience.

Business problems addressed

- Bad data creates unreliable forecasts and investment decisions.
- Slow routing delays follow-up and can reduce the chance of conversion.
- Limited visibility makes deal risk and performance issues harder to identify.
- Manual administration uses time that could be spent on customers.

3 Revenue metrics and pipeline management

Metrics need consistent scope, time periods and denominators. A dashboard should explain what each figure measures and how it is calculated.

Metric	Calculation and interpretation
Pipeline velocity	Qualified opportunities $\times$ win rate $\times$ average deal value $\div$ average sales cycle. Use matching cohorts and units.
Pipeline coverage	Eligible open pipeline $\div$ remaining target for the same period. Define which stages and close dates qualify.
Win rate	Closed-won opportunities $\div$ all closed opportunities $\times$ 100. Including open opportunities creates a different metric.
Forecast attainment	Actual revenue $\div$ forecast revenue $\times$ 100. The notes call this forecast accuracy; a value above 100 also signals forecast error.
Stage conversion	Records progressing to the next stage $\div$ records entering the stage $\times$ 100. Define the observation window.
Sales cycle	Days from a defined start event to close. Report an average or median and specify the deal cohort.
Average deal value	Total value of closed-won deals $\div$ number of closed-won deals. Use annualised contract value when naming this ACV.
Customer acquisition cost	Sales and Marketing acquisition spend $\div$ new customers acquired. Align spend and acquisition periods.
Net revenue retention	(Starting recurring revenue + expansion – contraction – churn) $\div$ starting recurring revenue $\times$ 100. Exclude new customers.

Pipeline stages and operating discipline

An example stage sequence in the notes is Prospecting, Discovery, Presentation, Proposal, Negotiation or Success Plan, Legal, and Closed Won or Closed Lost. Each stage needs clear entry and exit criteria; movement should reflect evidence from the buying process.

RevOps maintains accurate data, prepares leadership reporting, identifies at-risk deals and analyses why opportunities progress or fail. Forecasting combines stage evidence, deal context, coverage and the gap to target. Weighted pipeline should use a documented probability methodology.

The notes mention a 20–30% win rate and forecast performance above 90% as illustrative benchmarks. These are learning references, not universal targets; interpretation depends on the business and metric definition.

4 GTM technology and architecture

A GTM architecture defines where information lives, how it moves, what transformations occur and who owns each part. Tool names illustrate functions; they do not establish that a particular tool is required.

Layer	Purpose	Examples in the notes
System of record	Authoritative customer and deal records	Salesforce, HubSpot
Data storage	Historical snapshots and analysis	SQLite for practice; Snowflake, BigQuery
Transformation	Clean and model analytical data	dbt
Reverse ETL	Return modelled data to operational tools	Census, Hightouch
Enrichment	Add company and contact information	Clay, Cognism, ZoomInfo, Apollo
Orchestration	Trigger and coordinate workflows	n8n, Zapier, Make
Engagement	Support outreach and customer conversations	Outreach, Salesloft, Smartlead, Gong, AdRoll
Intelligence	Research, classification and narrative analysis	Claude, GPT, LLM APIs

Historical data and the CRM

A CRM is the operational record, while a separate data store can support historical analysis and pipeline snapshots. Define retention and snapshot rules explicitly. The notes describe an archive kept indefinitely; actual retention, deletion and history availability depend on the configured systems and policies.

Enrichment pipeline

The learning model has five steps: input records, waterfall enrichment, qualitative AI research, ICP scoring and output. Waterfall enrichment tries providers in sequence until the required information is found. Qualitative research can add context such as hiring activity, news or technology signals.

The proposed flow is: a lead enters Salesforce; n8n initiates enrichment; Clay returns additional information; an AI step evaluates ICP fit; approved fields are written back to Salesforce; the representative receives an alert. A CSV export appears in the notes as one possible transfer method.

Architecture decisions

Document identifiers, field mapping, authentication, ownership and error handling. Specify how duplicate records, missing data, retries and failed writes are handled. Preserve the evidence behind automated scores so users can understand the result.

5 AI workflows for revenue teams

Monday pipeline briefing

The example manual process takes 75 minutes: export pipeline data for 10 minutes, format it for 20, write commentary for 25, identify risks for 15 and format the email for 5. This is an illustrative baseline from the notes.

The proposed automation reads a pipeline export, assesses health by stage, selects three at-risk deals with reasons and highlights promising opportunities. The notes suggest starting at 7:50 on Monday for an 8:00 briefing. Scheduling, data access and delivery must be implemented and tested before unattended operation.

Daily deal risk alerts

A proposed n8n workflow checks open Salesforce deals at 7:30 for no activity in 14 or more days. An AI step drafts a contextual Slack message for the owner, including the last activity and a suggested next action. The 14-day rule is a starting example and should match the sales cycle.

Friday forecast commentary

Generate a three-paragraph leadership summary from current-quarter data: progress against target, material risks and the actions needed. Tie commentary to source records and use an agreed revenue definition.

Win and loss analysis

Analyse closed-won and closed-lost opportunities from the previous quarter. Combine deal data with Gong conversation evidence to examine competitor mentions, segment performance and reasons for outcomes. Treat inferred reasons as hypotheses where the source evidence is incomplete.

Inbound lead intelligence

Trigger enrichment when a new lead arrives, evaluate fit against the ICP, draft a relevant opening line, update approved CRM fields and notify the assigned representative. The notes include a 90-second enrichment example and a score from 1 to 10; these are proposed design choices, not measured results.

A five layer operating model

- Data foundation: CRM quality, enrichment, periodic audits and analytical reporting.
- Inbound intelligence: triggers, enrichment, ICP evaluation and routing.
- Pipeline intelligence: briefings and deal risk alerts.
- Revenue intelligence: win/loss analysis, attribution, forecasts and rep scorecards.
- Enablement: battlecards, sequences, coaching and onboarding materials.

6 Practical portfolio projects

The four core portfolio pieces in the notes can demonstrate reporting, enrichment, orchestration and analytics. Enrichment and lead intelligence overlap; they can share components while demonstrating different capabilities.

Project 1 Monday pipeline briefing

Problem: weekly reporting requires repetitive preparation and risks are difficult to scan manually. Build: a scheduled pipeline analysis and briefing with deal-level evidence. Measure: preparation and review time, data freshness, successful runs and the usefulness of risk flags.

Project 2 Lead enrichment pipeline

Problem: incomplete CRM records weaken segmentation and prioritisation. Build: a Clay enrichment process connected to Salesforce, adding relevant company characteristics and an explainable ICP score. Measure: completion rate, match accuracy, enrichment cost and incorrect writes.

Project 3 New lead intelligence workflow

Problem: new leads arrive without consistent context or timely follow-up. Build: n8n orchestration across Salesforce, enrichment, AI evaluation and Slack alerts. Measure: response time, routing accuracy, failed runs and manual effort. Show the trigger, decisions and writeback logic.

Project 4 Pipeline intelligence dashboard

Problem: leaders lack a consistent view of signed ARR, open pipeline and target coverage. Build: a Power BI dashboard showing signed ARR, weighted and unweighted pipeline, coverage and the gap to target. Measure: reconciliation to source data, reporting time and adoption.

Advanced project extensions

A multi-source customer health dashboard can combine Salesforce, Gong conversation signals and Asana project status. A win/loss analysis agent can use Gong transcripts as its main evidence source. Each extension needs a defined business question and a clear evaluation method.

Case study structure

- Problem: explain the missing or broken capability in business terms.
- Approach: describe the architecture, rules and decisions, with a simple diagram where useful.
- Tools: identify the actual systems and interfaces used.
- Outcome: record measured hours saved, quality changes or business results.
- Improvements: explain limitations and what to change next.

The first-person success story in the learning notes is a sample narrative. Replace it with actual implementation dates, run evidence, stakeholder feedback and measured outcomes before presenting it as personal experience.

7 Skills and career development

Roles and responsibilities

RevOps focuses on the shared revenue operating system, including process, data quality, reporting, forecasting and tool governance. GTM engineering emphasises building integrations, enrichment and automated execution. GTM architecture emphasises the overall design, data model, tool choices and scalability. Responsibilities can overlap; job titles alone do not define the scope.

Technical learning priorities

- SQL: query, join and analyse data. SQLBolt is recorded as a starting resource.
- n8n: learn triggers, workflow logic, integrations, retries and error handling.
- Clay: practise enrichment, waterfall logic and qualitative research.
- APIs, JSON and webhooks: understand documentation, authentication, payloads and event-driven connections. The notes suggest a REST APIs for non-developers course.
- AI and prompting: develop repeatable instructions, structured outputs and evidence-based review.
- Power BI: connect data, define measures and communicate revenue performance.

Business judgement

The learning plan also covers weighted forecasting, coverage and gap-to-target modelling; territory and compensation design; MEDDPICC and qualification; and the architecture of sales engagement tools such as Salesloft and Outreach. Technical fluency becomes more useful when linked to a revenue problem and a defensible calculation.

Career positioning and proof

The notes frame progression from approximately €68,000 toward €95,000–€96,000 as a career goal. They suggest demonstrating AI-powered workflows that save 10 or more hours per week and considering a €1,500 four-week freelance engagement. These are goals and positioning examples, not guaranteed compensation or achieved savings.

Create a one-page AI impact summary once systems are implemented. Include the problem, what was built, baseline and resulting effort, operating costs and limitations. Distinguish measured time savings from estimated revenue effects.

For LinkedIn, the notes recommend a headline focused on positioning and outcomes, plus an About section explaining what is built and why it matters. Malt.de is listed as a possible freelance profile channel.

Estimates that require evidence

The reading notes include European salary ranges of €80,000–€130,000 for GTM engineers and €120,000–€180,000 for architects, along with claims about conversion uplift, selling time and replacing SDR work. Keep these as unverified learning estimates. A 15–20% conversion improvement does not automatically produce the same percentage increase in annual revenue; attribution requires additional evidence.

8 Sources and learning status

The four source pages remain the reference for the learning material and proposed projects. This consolidated structure groups overlapping topics by function.

From 68k€ to 96k€

Career positioning, the initial tool stack, AI impact summary and four core projects.

[Open source in Notion](#)

The RevOps to GTM Architect Bible

Skill priorities, business judgement, advanced project ideas and case study structure.

[Open source in Notion](#)

The Complete AI RevOps and GTM University

RevOps foundations, customer journey, metrics, AI workflows and the five-layer operating model.

[Open source in Notion](#)

Read Posts Blogs and Websites about RevOps and GTM

Role comparisons, GTM technology layers and further reading notes.

[Open source in Notion](#)

Recorded learning status

The parent Notion page marks the AI RevOps and GTM University, the salary progression resource and the RevOps to GTM Architect Bible as completed. The following items remain unchecked:

- GTM Engineering Basic and GTM Engineering Playbook
- Michael Saruggia GTM Engineering
- Vanderbuild articles blogs and posts
- Further RevOps and GTM reading
- GTM Agents course from StackOptimise
- A second course to be determined
- Build a GTM and RevOps portfolio

An unchecked item records the status of the checklist; it does not establish that no work has begun. As projects progress, add evidence to the case studies and update the learning record.